

Goal 1: Body Transformation

A safe seven-month fat-loss, strength, sleep, and nutrition plan for a night-shift worker

Profile used: Age 23 | 174 cm | 95 kg | Ontario | GEODIS night shift | No gym months 1-4

Outcome to pursue: reach approximately 78-83 kg in seven months while preserving strength, improving sleep and work capacity, and building habits that can continue toward a lean athletic physique.

This is educational planning, not a diagnosis or individualized prescription. Because sex, medical history, and exact activity are not specified, calorie numbers are starting estimates and must be adjusted using your actual weight trend.

1. Reality check

At 174 cm, 95 kg corresponds to a BMI of about 31.4. At 65 kg, BMI would be about 21.5, which is within the conventional healthy BMI range. BMI is only a screening measure and does not determine the best muscular or athletic weight.

A safe seven-month loss is about 0.4-0.8 kg per week. A target of 78-83 kg is realistic; 65 kg is a longer-term option only if your waist, strength, energy, and health remain good. Approximately 8% body fat is not required for health. For a male it is very lean and difficult to maintain; for a female it would generally be dangerously low.

Face and belly fat cannot be reduced selectively. Facial definition and a visible waist improve through overall fat loss, resistance training, sleep, posture, hydration, and genetics. Avoid jaw exercisers, dehydration, starvation, and unregulated fat-loss products.

2. Seven-month body targets

Month	Weight trend	Strength	Cardio and steps	Recovery focus
1	1.5-3 kg loss	2 full-body sessions/week	90-120 min; 6,000 steps	Set sleep anchor; log food
2	7,000-8,000 steps	3 sessions/week	120-150 min	Protein consistency
3	8,000-9,000 steps	3 sessions; add backpack load	150-180 min	Improve technique
4	9,000-10,000 steps	3 sessions; harder variations	180-210 min	Prepare for gym
5	Begin gym; maintain loss	3 full-body gym sessions	2 moderate cardio sessions	Do not train through fatigue
6	Continue 0.4-0.7 kg/week	Progress weight slowly	150-210 min	One easier week if needed
7	Approximately 78-83 kg	Reassess strength and waist	Maintain sustainable volume	Choose next long-term phase

3. Calories, protein, and meal structure

Start with a two-week calibration at approximately 2,400 kcal per day on average and 140-160 g protein. Weigh after waking, calculate a seven-day average, and change calories only from the trend. If you are not male or your activity is much lower than assumed, use a calorie calculator or a registered dietitian to refine the starting number.

Aim for approximately 1.6-2.0 g protein per kilogram of target body weight. For a target around 78-83 kg, 140-160 g per day is practical. Divide protein across three or four meals.

Timing	Low-cost template
After waking	Oats, Greek yogurt, berries or banana, peanut butter, and eggs
Before shift	Chicken thighs, tofu, lentils, or beans with rice or potatoes and frozen vegetables
Mid-shift	Tuna-and-bean or chicken wrap, fruit, yogurt, and water
After shift	Milk, cottage cheese, yogurt, banana, or a light egg/tofu meal; avoid a huge meal immediately before sleep

Weekly staples: oats, eggs, Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, milk, chicken thighs, canned tuna or salmon, tofu, lentils, beans, rice, potatoes, whole-wheat wraps, frozen vegetables, cabbage, carrots, onions, bananas, apples, and frozen berries. Health Canada recommends vegetables and fruit, whole grains, protein foods, water, and limiting highly processed foods.

4. Home training: months 1-4

Train two days in month 1, then three days per week. Stop each set with about 2-3 controlled repetitions left. Add repetitions first, then backpack load, then a set.

Workout A	Workout B
Chair or body-weight squat: 2-4 x 8-15	Step-up: 2-4 x 8-12/side
Incline push-up: 2-4 x 6-15	Push-up progression: 2-4 x 6-15
Backpack row: 2-4 x 8-15	One-arm backpack row: 2-4 x 8-15/side
Backpack Romanian deadlift: 2-4 x 8-15	Glute bridge: 2-4 x 10-20
Reverse lunge: 2-3 x 6-12/side	Pike push-up or backpack press: 2-3 x 6-12
Dead bug and calf raise	Side plank and wall slides

Cardio is mainly brisk walking at a pace where you can speak in short sentences. Use a 5-10 minute mobility routine daily: chin tucks, wall slides, thoracic extension, hip-flexor stretch, ankle mobility, and gentle hamstring work.

5. Gym training: months 5-7

Use three full-body sessions, not an exhausting bodybuilding split. Begin with machines or light dumbbells while learning technique. Keep two moderate cardio sessions.

Session A	Session B	Session C
Leg press or goblet squat	Squat variation	Hip thrust or trap-bar deadlift
Bench or machine press	Incline dumbbell press	Chest-supported row
Lat pulldown	Seated cable row	Leg press or step-up
Romanian deadlift	Split squat	Leg curl
Lateral raise; plank	Shoulder press; curls/triceps	Assisted pull-up; farmer carry

Most exercises can use 3 sets of 6-12 repetitions. Add weight only when all repetitions are controlled. If sleep is poor or your warehouse shift is extended, reduce sets rather than forcing a hard session.

6. Tracking, plateaus, and safety

Frequency	Record
Daily	Morning weight, calories, protein, sleep duration, energy 1-5
Weekly	Seven-day weight average, waist at navel, step average, strength sessions, cardio minutes
Monthly	Front/side/back photos, best repetitions or loads, clothing fit, sleep trend

- 1 If the seven-day average has not moved for three weeks, check portions, liquid calories, weekend eating, and steps.
- 2 Then add 1,500-2,000 steps per day or reduce approximately 150 kcal per day.
- 3 If you are losing more than about 0.8-1.0 kg per week for two weeks, or you feel dizzy or weak, add 150-200 kcal and seek advice.
- 4 Never use dehydration, laxatives, starvation, or a very-low-calorie diet without medical supervision.

Seek medical help for chest pain, fainting, severe shortness of breath, repeated vomiting, severe weakness, black or bloody stool, or an injury that prevents normal movement. Ask a doctor about persistent insomnia, loud snoring, gasping, or severe daytime sleepiness.

7. Night-shift recovery plan

- Protect a consistent sleep block. On the normal shift, a target such as 4:30 a.m. to 12:30 p.m. may work; on peak weeks move the block later rather than cutting it short.
- Use a dark, cool room, eye mask, earplugs or white noise, and a 20-30 minute wind-down.
- Avoid caffeine approximately eight hours before planned sleep and avoid a very heavy meal immediately before bed.
- If a shift ends at 4:30 a.m., do only light mobility or walking the next day and use Friday/Saturday for deeper study and training.

8. Minimum viable day

- Sleep for the planned block.
- Drink water and eat one protein-and-vegetable meal.
- Walk 10 minutes and do 5 minutes of mobility.
- Do 15 minutes of language review.
- Spend 10 minutes on IT or English, alternating days.
- Log weight, sleep, and energy.

Sources and verification links

CDC, Steps for Losing Weight | <https://www.cdc.gov/healthy-weight-growth/losing-weight/index.html>

Health Canada, Healthy Eating Recommendations | <https://www.canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/food-guide/explore/healthy-eating-recommendations.html>

Protein and resistance training meta-analysis | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/28698222/>

Transport Canada, fatigue management for employees | <https://tc.canada.ca/en/aviation/commercial-air-services/fatigue-management-aviation/fatigue-risk-management-employees>